

Micah

¹ The word of the LORD that came to Micah the Morasthite in the days of Jotham, Ahaz, *and* Hezekiah, kings of Judah, which he saw concerning Samaria and Jerusalem.

² Hear, all ye people; hearken, O earth, and all that therein is: and let the Lord GOD be witness against you, the Lord from his holy temple.*†

³ For, behold, the LORD cometh forth out of his place, and will come down, and tread upon the high places of the earth.

⁴ And the mountains shall be molten under him, and the valleys shall be cleft, as wax before the fire, *and* as the waters *that are* poured down a steep place.‡

⁵ For the transgression of Jacob *is* all this, and for the sins of the house of Israel. What *is* the transgression of Jacob? *is it* not Samaria? and what *are* the high places of Judah? *are they* not Jerusalem?

⁶ Therefore I will make Samaria as an heap of the field, *and* as plantings of a vineyard: and I will pour down the stones thereof into the valley, and I will discover the foundations thereof.

⁷ And all the graven images thereof shall be beaten to pieces, and all the hires thereof shall be burned with the fire, and all the idols thereof will I lay desolate: for she gathered *it* of the hire of an harlot, and they shall return to the hire of an harlot.

⁸ Therefore I will wail and howl, I will go stripped and naked: I will make a wailing like the dragons, and mourning as the owls.§

⁹ For her wound *is* incurable; for it *is* come unto Judah; he *is* come unto the gate of my people, *even* to Jerusalem.**

¹⁰ ¶ Declare ye *it* not at Gath, weep ye not at all: in the house of Aphrah roll thyself in the dust.††

¹¹ Pass ye away, thou inhabitant of Saphir, having thy shame naked: the inhabitant of Zaanan came not forth in the mourning of Beth-ezel; he shall receive of you his standing.‡‡§§***†††

¹² For the inhabitant of Maroth waited carefully for good: but evil came down from the LORD unto the gate of Jerusalem.‡‡‡§§§

¹³ O thou inhabitant of Lachish, bind the chariot to the swift beast: she *is* the beginning of the sin to the daughter of Zion: for the transgressions of Israel were found in thee.*

¹⁴ Therefore shalt thou give presents to Moresheth-gath: the houses of Achzib *shall* be a lie to the kings of Israel.†‡

¹⁵ Yet will I bring an heir unto thee, O inhabitant of Mareshah: he shall come unto Adullam the glory of Israel.§**

¹⁶ Make thee bald, and poll thee for thy delicate children; enlarge thy baldness as the eagle; for they are gone into captivity from thee.

* 1:2 all ye...: Heb. ye people, all of them † 1:2 all that...: Heb. the fulness thereof ‡ 1:4 a steep...: Heb. a descent
 § 1:8 owls: Heb. daughters of the owl ** 1:9 her...: or, she is grievously sick of her wounds †† 1:10 Aphrah: that is, Dust ‡‡ 1:11 thou...: or, thou that dwellest fairly §§ 1:11 inhabitant: Heb. inhabitress *** 1:11 Zaanan: or, The country of flocks ††† 1:11 Beth-ezel: or, A place near ‡‡‡ 1:12 inhabitant: Heb. inhabitress §§§ 1:12 waited...: or, was grieved * 1:13 inhabitant: Heb. inhabitress † 1:14 to...: or, for Moresheth-gath ‡ 1:14 Achzib: that is, A lie § 1:15 inhabitant: Heb. inhabitress ** 1:15 he...: or, the glory of Israel shall, etc

2

¹ Woe to them that devise iniquity, and work evil upon their beds! when the morning is light, they practise it, because it is in the power of their hand.

² And they covet fields, and take *them* by violence; and houses, and take *them* away: so they oppress a man and his house, even a man and his heritage.*

³ Therefore thus saith the LORD; Behold, against this family do I devise an evil, from which ye shall not remove your necks; neither shall ye go haughtily: for this time is evil.

⁴ ¶ In that day shall *one* take up a parable against you, and lament with a doleful lamentation, *and* say, We be utterly spoiled: he hath changed the portion of my people: how hath he removed *it* from me! turning away he hath divided our fields.††

⁵ Therefore thou shalt have none that shall cast a cord by lot in the congregation of the LORD.

⁶ Prophecy ye not, *say they to them that* prophecy: they shall not prophecy to them, *that* they shall not take shame.§

⁷ ¶ O *thou that art* named the house of Jacob, is the spirit of the LORD straitened? *are* these his doings? do not my words do good to him that walketh uprightly?***††

⁸ Even of late my people is risen up as an enemy: ye pull off the robe with the garment from them that pass by securely as men averse from war.‡§§

⁹ The women of my people have ye cast out from their pleasant houses; from their children have ye taken away my glory for ever.***

¹⁰ Arise ye, and depart; for this is not *your* rest: because it is polluted, it shall destroy *you*, even with a sore destruction.

¹¹ If a man walking in the spirit and falsehood do lie, *saying*, I will prophecy unto thee of wine and of strong drink; he shall even be the prophet of this people.†††

¹² ¶ I will surely assemble, O Jacob, all of thee; I will surely gather the remnant of Israel; I will put them together as the sheep of Bozrah, as the flock in the midst of their fold: they shall make great noise by reason of *the multitude of* men.

¹³ The breaker is come up before them: they have broken up, and have passed through the gate, and are gone out by it: and their king shall pass before them, and the LORD on the head of them.

3

¹ And I said, Hear, I pray you, O heads of Jacob, and ye princes of the house of Israel; *Is it* not for you to know judgment?

² Who hate the good, and love the evil; who pluck off their skin from off them, and their flesh from off their bones;

³ Who also eat the flesh of my people, and flay their skin from off them; and they break their bones, and chop them in pieces, as for the pot, and as flesh within the caldron.

⁴ Then shall they cry unto the LORD, but he will not hear them: he will even hide his face from them at that time, as they have behaved themselves ill in their doings.

⁵ ¶ Thus saith the LORD concerning the prophets that make my people err; that bite with their teeth, and cry, Peace; and he that putteth not into their mouths, they even prepare war against him.

* 2:2 oppress: or, defraud † 2:4 a doleful...: Heb. a lamentation of lamentations ‡ 2:4 turning...: or, instead of restoring § 2:6 Prophecy ye...: or, Prophecy not as they prophecy: Heb. Drop, etc ** 2:7 straitened: or, shortened? †† 2:7 uprightly: Heb. upright? ‡‡ 2:8 of late: Heb. yesterday §§ 2:8 with the: Heb. over against a *** 2:9 women: or, wives ††† 2:11 walking...: or, walk with the wind, and lie falsely

⁶ Therefore night *shall be* unto you, that ye shall not have a vision; and it shall be dark unto you, that ye shall not divine; and the sun shall go down over the prophets, and the day shall be dark over them.*†

⁷ Then shall the seers be ashamed, and the diviners confounded: yea, they shall all cover their lips; for *there is* no answer of God.‡

⁸ ¶ But truly I am full of power by the spirit of the LORD, and of judgment, and of might, to declare unto Jacob his transgression, and to Israel his sin.

⁹ Hear this, I pray you, ye heads of the house of Jacob, and princes of the house of Israel, that abhor judgment, and pervert all equity.

¹⁰ They build up Zion with blood, and Jerusalem with iniquity.§

¹¹ The heads thereof judge for reward, and the priests thereof teach for hire, and the prophets thereof divine for money: yet will they lean upon the LORD, and say, *Is not* the LORD among us? none evil can come upon us.**

¹² Therefore shall Zion for your sake be plowed *as* a field, and Jerusalem shall become heaps, and the mountain of the house as the high places of the forest.

4

¹ But in the last days it shall come to pass, *that* the mountain of the house of the LORD shall be established in the top of the mountains, and it shall be exalted above the hills; and people shall flow unto it.

² And many nations shall come, and say, Come, and let us go up to the mountain of the LORD, and to the house of the God of Jacob; and he will teach us of his ways, and we will walk in his paths: for the law shall go forth of Zion, and the word of the LORD from Jerusalem.

³ ¶ And he shall judge among many people, and rebuke strong nations afar off; and they shall beat their swords into plowshares, and their spears into pruninghooks: nation shall not lift up a sword against nation, neither shall they learn war any more.*

⁴ But they shall sit every man under his vine and under his fig tree; and none shall make *them* afraid: for the mouth of the LORD of hosts hath spoken *it*.

⁵ For all people will walk every one in the name of his god, and we will walk in the name of the LORD our God for ever and ever.

⁶ In that day, saith the LORD, will I assemble her that halteth, and I will gather her that is driven out, and her that I have afflicted;

⁷ And I will make her that halted a remnant, and her that was cast far off a strong nation: and the LORD shall reign over them in mount Zion from henceforth, even for ever.

⁸ ¶ And thou, O tower of the flock, the strong hold of the daughter of Zion, unto thee shall it come, even the first dominion; the kingdom shall come to the daughter of Jerusalem.

⁹ Now why dost thou cry out aloud? *is there* no king in thee? is thy counsellor perished? for pangs have taken thee as a woman in travail.

¹⁰ Be in pain, and labour to bring forth, O daughter of Zion, like a woman in travail: for now shalt thou go forth out of the city, and thou shalt dwell in the field, and thou shalt go *even* to Babylon; there shalt thou be delivered; there the LORD shall redeem thee from the hand of thine enemies.

¹¹ ¶ Now also many nations are gathered against thee, that say, Let her be defiled, and let our eye look upon Zion.

* 3:6 that...: vision: Heb. from a vision † 3:6 that...: divine: Heb. from divining ‡ 3:7 lips: Heb. upper lip
§ 3:10 blood: Heb. bloods ** 3:11 and say: Heb. saying * 4:3 pruninghooks: or, scythes

¹² But they know not the thoughts of the LORD, neither understand they his counsel: for he shall gather them as the sheaves into the floor.

¹³ Arise and thresh, O daughter of Zion: for I will make thine horn iron, and I will make thy hoofs brass: and thou shalt beat in pieces many people: and I will consecrate their gain unto the LORD, and their substance unto the Lord of the whole earth.

5

¹ Now gather thyself in troops, O daughter of troops: he hath laid siege against us: they shall smite the judge of Israel with a rod upon the cheek.

² But thou, Beth-lehem Ephratah, *though* thou be little among the thousands of Judah, yet out of thee shall he come forth unto me *that is* to be ruler in Israel; whose goings forth *have been* from of old, from everlasting.*

³ Therefore will he give them up, until the time *that* she which travaileth hath brought forth: then the remnant of his brethren shall return unto the children of Israel.

⁴ ¶ And he shall stand and feed in the strength of the LORD, in the majesty of the name of the LORD his God; and they shall abide: for now shall he be great unto the ends of the earth.†

⁵ And this *man* shall be the peace, when the Assyrian shall come into our land: and when he shall tread in our palaces, then shall we raise against him seven shepherds, and eight principal men.‡

⁶ And they shall waste the land of Assyria with the sword, and the land of Nimrod in the entrances thereof: thus shall he deliver *us* from the Assyrian, when he cometh into our land, and when he treadeth within our borders.§**

⁷ And the remnant of Jacob shall be in the midst of many people as a dew from the LORD, as the showers upon the grass, that tarrieth not for man, nor waiteth for the sons of men.

⁸ ¶ And the remnant of Jacob shall be among the Gentiles in the midst of many people as a lion among the beasts of the forest, as a young lion among the flocks of sheep: who, if he go through, both treadeth down, and teareth in pieces, and none can deliver.††

⁹ Thine hand shall be lifted up upon thine adversaries, and all thine enemies shall be cut off.

¹⁰ And it shall come to pass in that day, saith the LORD, that I will cut off thy horses out of the midst of thee, and I will destroy thy chariots:

¹¹ And I will cut off the cities of thy land, and throw down all thy strong holds:

¹² And I will cut off witchcrafts out of thine hand; and thou shalt have no *more* soothsayers:

¹³ Thy graven images also will I cut off, and thy standing images out of the midst of thee; and thou shalt no more worship the work of thine hands.‡‡

¹⁴ And I will pluck up thy groves out of the midst of thee: so will I destroy thy cities.§§

¹⁵ And I will execute vengeance in anger and fury upon the heathen, such as they have not heard.

6

¹ Hear ye now what the LORD saith; Arise, contend thou before the mountains, and let the hills hear thy voice.*

² Hear ye, O mountains, the LORD's controversy, and ye strong foundations of the earth: for the LORD hath a controversy with his people, and he will plead with Israel.

* 5:2 everlasting: Heb. the days of eternity † 5:4 feed: or, rule ‡ 5:5 principal: Heb. princes of § 5:6 waste: Heb. eat up ** 5:6 in the...: or, with her own naked swords †† 5:8 sheep: or, goats ‡‡ 5:13 standing...: or, statues §§ 5:14 cities: or, enemies * 6:1 before: or, with

³ O my people, what have I done unto thee? and wherein have I wearied thee? testify against me.

⁴ For I brought thee up out of the land of Egypt, and redeemed thee out of the house of servants; and I sent before thee Moses, Aaron, and Miriam.

⁵ O my people, remember now what Balak king of Moab consulted, and what Balaam the son of Beor answered him from Shittim unto Gilgal; that ye may know the righteousness of the LORD.

⁶ ¶ Wherewith shall I come before the LORD, *and* bow myself before the high God? shall I come before him with burnt offerings, with calves of a year old?†

⁷ Will the LORD be pleased with thousands of rams, *or* with ten thousands of rivers of oil? shall I give my firstborn *for* my transgression, the fruit of my body *for* the sin of my soul?‡

⁸ He hath shewed thee, O man, what *is* good; and what doth the LORD require of thee, but to do justly, and to love mercy, and to walk humbly with thy God?§

⁹ The LORD's voice crieth unto the city, and *the man of wisdom* shall see thy name: hear ye the rod, and who hath appointed it.**

¹⁰ ¶ Are there yet the treasures of wickedness in the house of the wicked, and the scant measure *that is* abominable?†††

¹¹ Shall I count *them* pure with the wicked balances, and with the bag of deceitful weights?§§

¹² For the rich men thereof are full of violence, and the inhabitants thereof have spoken lies, and their tongue *is* deceitful in their mouth.

¹³ Therefore also will I make *thee* sick in smiting thee, in making *thee* desolate because of thy sins.

¹⁴ Thou shalt eat, but not be satisfied; and thy casting down *shall be* in the midst of thee; and thou shalt take hold, but shalt not deliver; and *that* which thou deliverest will I give up to the sword.

¹⁵ Thou shalt sow, but thou shalt not reap; thou shalt tread the olives, but thou shalt not anoint thee with oil; and sweet wine, but shalt not drink wine.

¹⁶ ¶ For the statutes of Omri are kept, and all the works of the house of Ahab, and ye walk in their counsels; that I should make thee a desolation, and the inhabitants thereof an hissing: therefore ye shall bear the reproach of my people.***†††

7

¹ Woe is me! for I am as when they have gathered the summer fruits, as the grape gleanings of the vintage: *there is* no cluster to eat: my soul desired the firstripe fruit.*

² The good *man* is perished out of the earth: and *there is* none upright among men: they all lie in wait for blood; they hunt every man his brother with a net.†

³ ¶ That they may do evil with both hands earnestly, the prince asketh, and the judge *asketh* for a reward; and the great *man*, he uttereth his mischievous desire: so they wrap it up.‡

⁴ The best of them *is* as a brier: the most upright *is sharper* than a thorn hedge: the day of thy watchmen *and* thy visitation cometh; now shall be their perplexity.

† 6:6 of a...: Heb. sons of a year? ‡ 6:7 body: Heb. belly § 6:8 walk...: Heb. humble thyself to walk ** 6:9 the man...: or, thy name shall see that which is †† 6:10 Are...: or, Is there yet unto every man an house of the, etc ‡‡ 6:10 scant...: Heb. measure of leanness §§ 6:11 count...: or, be pure with, etc *** 6:16 For the...: or, For he doth much keep the, etc ††† 6:16 desolation: or, astonishment * 7:1 when...: Heb. the gatherings of summer † 7:2 good: or, godly, or, merciful ‡ 7:3 his...: Heb. the mischief of his soul

⁵ ¶ Trust ye not in a friend, put ye not confidence in a guide: keep the doors of thy mouth from her that lieth in thy bosom.

⁶ For the son dishonoureth the father, the daughter riseth up against her mother, the daughter in law against her mother in law; a man's enemies *are* the men of his own house.

⁷ Therefore I will look unto the LORD; I will wait for the God of my salvation: my God will hear me.

⁸ ¶ Rejoice not against me, O mine enemy: when I fall, I shall arise; when I sit in darkness, the LORD *shall be* a light unto me.

⁹ I will bear the indignation of the LORD, because I have sinned against him, until he plead my cause, and execute judgment for me: he will bring me forth to the light, *and* I shall behold his righteousness.

¹⁰ Then *she that is* mine enemy shall see *it*, and shame shall cover her which said unto me, Where is the LORD thy God? mine eyes shall behold her: now shall she be trodden down as the mire of the streets. §**

¹¹ In the day that thy walls are to be built, *in* that day shall the decree be far removed.

¹² In that day *also* he shall come even to thee from Assyria, and *from* the fortified cities, and from the fortress even to the river, and from sea to sea, and *from* mountain to mountain. ††

¹³ Notwithstanding the land shall be desolate because of them that dwell therein, for the fruit of their doings. ‡‡

¹⁴ ¶ Feed thy people with thy rod, the flock of thine heritage, which dwell solitarily *in* the wood, in the midst of Carmel: let them feed *in* Bashan and Gilead, as in the days of old. §§

¹⁵ According to the days of thy coming out of the land of Egypt will I shew unto him marvellous *things*.

¹⁶ ¶ The nations shall see and be confounded at all their might: they shall lay *their* hand upon *their* mouth, their ears shall be deaf.

¹⁷ They shall lick the dust like a serpent, they shall move out of their holes like worms of the earth: they shall be afraid of the LORD our God, and shall fear because of thee. ***

¹⁸ Who *is* a God like unto thee, that pardoneth iniquity, and passeth by the transgression of the remnant of his heritage? he retaineth not his anger for ever, because he delighteth *in* mercy.

¹⁹ He will turn again, he will have compassion upon us; he will subdue our iniquities; and thou wilt cast all their sins into the depths of the sea.

²⁰ Thou wilt perform the truth to Jacob, *and* the mercy to Abraham, which thou hast sworn unto our fathers from the days of old.

§ 7:10 Then...: or, And thou wilt see her that is mine enemy, and cover her with shame ** 7:10 shall she...: Heb. she shall be for a treading down †† 7:12 and from the fortified cities: or, even to the fortified cities ‡‡ 7:13 Notwithstanding: or, After that it hath been §§ 7:14 Feed: or, Rule *** 7:17 worms: or, creeping things